

INDIA'S GUKESH BECOMES THE YOUNGEST WORLD CHESS CHAMPION

Indian teen prodigy D. Gukesh became the world's youngest undisputed world chess champion yesterday after beating China's Ding Liren in the final match of their series in Singapore. The 18-year-old became "the YOUNGEST WORLD CHAMPION in history", said the International Chess Federation in a post on social media platform X, after Ding resigned in a thrilling endgame that had been expected to end in a draw. Gukesh surpassed the achievement of Russia's Garry Kasparov, who won the title at 22.

Courtesy: Twitter

SEE ALSO P12



Dubai offplans now at zero deposit?

Developers offer flexible pricing options to lift year-end sales

DUBAI
BY MANOJ NAIR
Business Editor

Even as developers face intense competition with frequent new launches, December is shaping up to be the best year for offplan property sales in Dubai. To stand out, some developers are offering zero down payment promotions as limited-time offers, aiming to accelerate decision-making among investors. These incentives are expected to become even more attractive in 2025 if market demand slows, providing easier paths to home ownership. Additionally, many developers assist with Golden Visa processing for investors committing to properties valued at Dh2 million or more. Other innovative offerings include dynamic pricing, where buyers can choose flexible payment plans that alter the final property price based on their preferences. While dynamic pricing is still new in Dubai, it offers flexibility for buyers and developers alike. However, experts advise potential buyers to carefully evaluate the overall value of these deals and compare them to traditional mortgage options, ensuring they understand the long-term financial implications before committing.

SEE ALSO P5

WORLD

India's federal cabinet approves One Nation, One Election bill | P11

ENTERTAINMENT

Forever begins now: Selena Gomez engaged to Benny Blanco | P15

FRIDAY

Sartorial trends & top dining & travel options for the festive season



SPORT

Cristiano Ronaldo: The future is bright for Saudi Arabia | P12

G7 support for Syria's inclusive transition

GROUP ALSO URGES ACCOUNTABILITY FOR AL ASSAD REGIME'S CRIMES

DUBAI
BY STEPHEN N. R.
Senior Associate Editor

The Group of Seven (G7) nations yesterday announced their readiness to support Syria's transition to an inclusive, non-sectarian government following the ousting of President Bashar Al Assad. Days after a swift offensive led by the Islamist Hayat Tahrir Al Sham (HTS) group forced Al Assad to flee, the G7 urged accountability for his regime's crimes and emphasised the protection of human rights, including those of women and minorities. "After decades of atrocities committed by the Al Assad regime, we stand with the people of Syria," the G7 said, reaffirming support for a Syrian-led political transition aligned with UN Security Council Resolution 2254. The G7 stressed maintaining Syria's territorial integrity, preventing institutional collapse, and ensuring the safe return of refugees, pledging to back a future Syrian government that ensures human rights, rule of law, and accountability. Syria's interim government yesterday vowed to institute the "rule of law". The new government's spokesman said that the country's constitution and parliament would be suspended for the duration of a three-month transition. US Secretary of State Antony Blinken, during a visit to Jordan, cautioned against further conflicts in Syria amid rising tensions. "It's important that all actors with interests in Syria ensure we're not sparking additional conflicts at this critical moment," he said.

Turkey's strategic moves

Turkish intelligence chief Ibrahim Kalin was seen in Damascus, signalling Turkey's growing influence in post-Al Assad Syria. Kalin's visit to the Umayyad Mosque symbolically echoed Turkish President Recep Tayyip Erdogan's 2012 remarks about one day praying there.

SEE ALSO P11

US Secretary of State Antony Blinken, during a visit to Jordan, cautioned against further conflicts in Syria amid rising tensions.



only NATURAL DIAMONDS
Natural Diamond Council



Eternal Elegance Unveiled

A festival of stunning diamond jewellery, showcasing an experience of eternal sparkle! From the mines to your hearts, each piece born out of timeless, certified and responsibly sourced diamonds makes your moments magical.



FREE CASH VOUCHERS

FREE AED 100 CASH VOUCHER ON EVERY AED 3,000 WORTH DIAMOND & PRECIOUS GEM JEWELLERY PURCHASE



100% VALUE ON DIAMOND EXCHANGE

MALABAR
GOLD & DIAMONDS

 COMPLETE TRANSPARENCY

 TESTED & CERTIFIED DIAMONDS

 ASSURED LIFETIME MAINTENANCE

 100% GUARANTEED BUYBACK

 RESPONSIBLY SOURCED PRODUCTS

OVER 370 BRANCHES ACROSS UAE, OMAN, BAHRAIN, KUWAIT, QATAR, KSA, SINGAPORE, MALAYSIA, USA, CANADA, UK, AUSTRALIA & INDIA | Shop 24/7 at www.malabargoldanddiamonds.com

*T & C Apply. Offer valid until 12th January 2025